17.12 Nephrotic Syndrome in Children*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Mother says, "His eyes and belly are swollen." **Objective** • Puffy eyes and generalized edema • Heavy proteinuria • Low albumin	**ACTUAL** Excessive fluid volume related to protein loss and low plasma oncotic pressure as evidenced by edema and proteinuria.	• Less edema and protein-free urine within 2–4 weeks of corticosteroids.	• Weigh daily and measure abdominal girth. • Test urine for protein each day. • Give corticosteroids as prescribed. • Restrict salt as ordered.	• Achieved as edema decreases.
Subjective • Child says, "Other children laugh at my face." **Objective** • Cushingoid face from corticosteroids • Refuses to go to school	**ACTUAL** Disrupted body image related to edema and corticosteroid effects as evidenced by distress about appearance.	• Talks about his feelings and keeps up social activities.	• Explain that the changes will pass. • Encourage school attendance when he is well.	• Outcome reached when he is coping.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • On corticosteroids • Losing immunoglobulin	**RISK** Risk for infection as evidenced by risk factors: corticosteroid therapy and protein loss.	• No infection.	• Ask the parents to report fever and abdominal pain, which may mean peritonitis. • Keep him away from chickenpox and measles. • Reinforce hand hygiene.	• Considered met if no infection develops.

* **References for this care plan:** [17], [35], [38]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.